

SENATE No. 425

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Jacob R. Oliveira

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to promote the inclusion of American Sign Language in the Commonwealth's public schools, AKA The American Sign Language Inclusion Act.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Jacob R. Oliveira</i>	<i>Hampden, Hampshire and Worcester</i>	
<i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>	<i>5th Barnstable</i>	<i>2/24/2025</i>
<i>Antonio F. D. Cabral</i>	<i>13th Bristol</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>
<i>Patrick M. O'Connor</i>	<i>First Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>3/24/2025</i>
<i>Carlos González</i>	<i>10th Hampden</i>	<i>5/23/2025</i>
<i>Lisa Field</i>	<i>3rd Bristol</i>	<i>9/3/2025</i>
<i>John J. Marsi</i>	<i>6th Worcester</i>	<i>9/16/2025</i>

SENATE No. 425

By Mr. Oliveira, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 425) of Jacob R. Oliveira, Steven George Xiarhos and Antonio F. D. Cabral for legislation to promote the inclusion of American Sign Language in the Commonwealth’s public schools. Education.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 338 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to promote the inclusion of American Sign Language in the Commonwealth’s public schools, AKA The American Sign Language Inclusion Act.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 2B of Chapter 71 of the general Laws, as appearing in the 2020
2 Official Edition is hereby amended by striking out the words, in line 4, “may be taught” and
3 inserting in place thereof the following: “shall be taught in each of the Commonwealth’s
4 secondary schools”

5 SECTION 2. Section 2B of Chapter 71 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020
6 Official Edition is hereby amended by inserting, after the word “society” in line 8 the following:-
7 “As many children with autism have been able to learn and communicate successfully via sign
8 language because it is visually based, unaided, and provides a mode of quick communication.”

9 SECTION 3. Section 2B of Chapter 71 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020
10 Official Edition is hereby further amended by striking out the word, in line 8, “may” and
11 inserting in place thereof the following: “shall”.